

DigiPick of the month

Triple-core?



This month's winner is
Manju Nath

JP Nagar
Bangalore

He wins
SAMS Teach Yourself EJB
by Ragae Ghaly
and Krishna
Kothapalli
Published by
Pearson
Education, Delhi



WIN!

Send in your entry and you could win an exciting gift just by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should be shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier. E-mail your picture with the subject **'DigiPick'** and your postal address **on or before 15th of this month** to digipick@thinkdigit.com. One prize-winning picture will be published each month.

MOBILE TV COMING SOON?

Emmys For Mobile Content

The US National Academy of Television Arts and Sciences, which gives out the annual Daytime Emmy Awards, has introduced a new category to reward creators of content for mobile phones and other portable media devices such as the Video iPod and the Sony PSP.

The new category will recognise "outstanding achievement in content for non-traditional delivery platforms." To be eligible for the awards, the shows have to be created specifically for mobile devices, and cannot be spin-offs of existing TV shows. The shows must be less than 20 minutes in length.

"What we are seeing is a burgeoning rise in this type of programme making," Peter Price, president of the Academy told the BBC News Web site. It certainly does seem that way.

Apple has inked a deal with ABC, the largest broadcaster in the US, and Disney, to offer legal downloads of TV hits such as *Lost* and *Desperate Housewives* for the Video iPod. In addition to this, Apple is also planning to offer brand-new animation content from Pixar.

Rupert Murdoch's News Corporation that owns the Fox network, and a number of Hollywood studios—including Twentieth Century Fox—is also

putting up a mobile-only version of their hit TV show 24. Other channels and networks such as MTV are also developing content for this platform.

STAMP OUT THE SMUT!

The Pixels Say It All

PixAlert is an Irish smut-busting firm, and the name, as you'll see, has rhyme and reason to it.

It has developed technology which, it claims, "completely prevents pornographic images being displayed and viewed on computer screens" by blocking "illegal or inappropriate images as they are rendered."

PixAlert says they manage to do it using "high-speed image analysis software" that can detect "images actually being displayed on any screen and originating from any computer source."

Understandably, there's a good market for the technology, because as PixAlert marketing manager Andy Churley explains,

People Who Changed Computing

The Searchmeisters

Larry Page and his partner Sergey Brin have changed the way people use the Internet—they co-founded Google.

Page and Brin were just computer science grad

students at Stanford when they came up with a search algorithm. That was back in 1995. The two were not



Page and Brin

a made-for-each-other pairing: their first meeting was anything but cordial, and has become part of Google lore. Their opinions differed so much they frequently had showdowns. One thing they did agree on, however, was technology—technology that powered searchability.

By early 1996, Page and Brin had begun to collaborate on a search engine called BackRub. Their algorithm created a buzz at the Stanford campus, and the duo decided to put their PhDs on hold to set up Google and take it mainstream. There was one problem though—money. But soon enough, they were in talks with Andy Bechtolsheim of Sun. Bechtolsheim was impressed and wrote a \$100,000 cheque to "Google, Inc." Google didn't exist yet, so Brin and Page promptly incorporated their company.

Page and Brin managed the company until it grew to more than 200 employees in 2001. They then handed over the CEO position to Dr Eric Schmidt. Page still plays an important role in running the company, along with Schmidt and Brin.

After Google's IPO in September 2004, Page and Brin have become multi-billionaires: Forbes Magazine ranks Page as the 55th-richest man in the world. But the two still haven't earned their PhDs—they're both still technically on leave from the doctoral program at Stanford!



Illustration: Harsho Mohan Chatteraj